

2.6 Registering a route

When a user visits a URL controlled by Django, the web server calls the WSGI application defined in `wsgi.py` with the HTTP request information. Django uses its list of URL patterns defined in `urls.py` and tries to find a match. If a match gets found, the view associated with the URL pattern gets called. You have defined the home app with the `credits()` view in its `views.py` file; now, you need to register a URL route with that view.

The URL mappings in `urls.py` are contained in a list called `urlpatterns`. You define a mapping using a `path` object. When you used the `startproject` command to create your project, a bare-bones `urls.py` file got created. That generated file includes the import for `path` objects. Each `path` object requires at least two arguments: a URL pattern and a mapping. The mapping, in this case, is a reference to your `credits()` function. Mappings can also be references to other mapping files, giving the ability to create hierarchies of maps.

Your `path` object requires an actual reference to the `credits()` view—yes, the callable view function itself. Importing every view in your project would take up a lot of space, so it is common practice to import the view module and then dot-reference the function inside.

`RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py` is the central place for all URL definitions. All apps register routes in this file, and because every app names its view file `views.py`, this can get confusing. To make your `urls.py` clearer, use the `import ... as` pattern to rename your imported module. For example, instead of using `from home import views`, you rename the imported module as `from home import views as home_views`.

Django includes a management tool called the Django Admin—not to be confused with the `django-admin` command, which is completely unrelated. By default, the `urlpatterns` list includes a mapping for the Django Admin. When you register your `credits` view, you'll be adding this along with the existing mapping. To do this, open `RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py` and change it to look like the following listing. A future chapter covers the Django Admin in detail.

Listing 2.3 Register your view

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/urls.py
from django.contrib import admin

from django.urls import path

from home import views as home_views

urlpatterns = [
    path("admin/", admin.site.urls),
    path('credits/', home_views.credits),
]
```

Import the home app, aliasing it.

Register the credits view function in the home app against the 'credits/' path.

Note the lack of a leading slash (/) in the `path` pattern. Django prefixes the leading slash for you. The URL `/credits/` is registered using `path("credits/")`. To register